Istanbul

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Hagia Sophia Grand Mosque

the magnificent heritage of the glorious conquest, theprecious entrustment of Fatih Sultan Mehmed Khan

History

- Hagia Sophia is a work that was constructed three times in

the same location. Today’s Hagia Sophia is known as the

“Third Hagia Sophia”.

- The first minaret of Hagia Sophia was built of wood during

the rule of Fatih Sultan Mehmed Khan. This minaret, which

existed for many years, was removed during the major repair

in 1574. The second minaret of the Hagia Sophia Mosque was

built of bricks during the rule of Sultan Bayezid II.

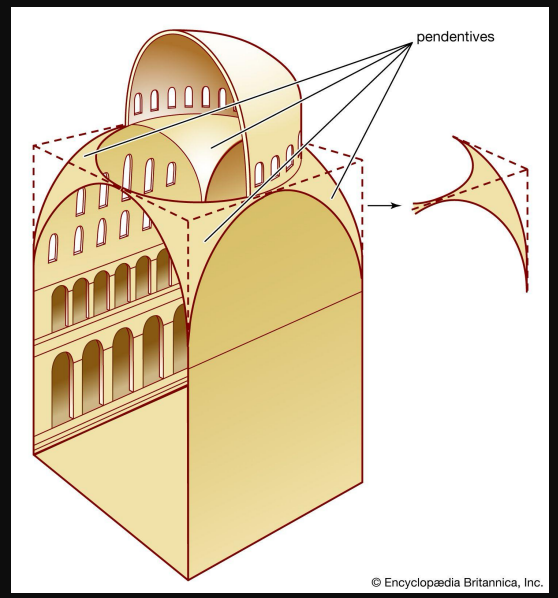
- Hagia Sophia, which was converted into a mosque with the

conquest and served as a mosque for 481 years, was closed

off to the public after the restoration works started in the 1930s.

Architecture

- The Hagia Sophia combines a longitudinal basilica and a centralized building in a wholly original manner, with a huge 105-foot (32-meter) main dome supported on pendentives and two semidomes, one on either side of the longitudinal axis. Though Justinian's domed basilicas are the models from which Byzantine architecture developed, the Hagia Sophia remained unique, and no attempt was thereafter made by Byzantine builders to emulate it. In plan the building is almost square, but, looked at from within, it appears to be rectangular, for the great semidomes at east and west prolong the effect of the roof.



Yerebatan sarnici

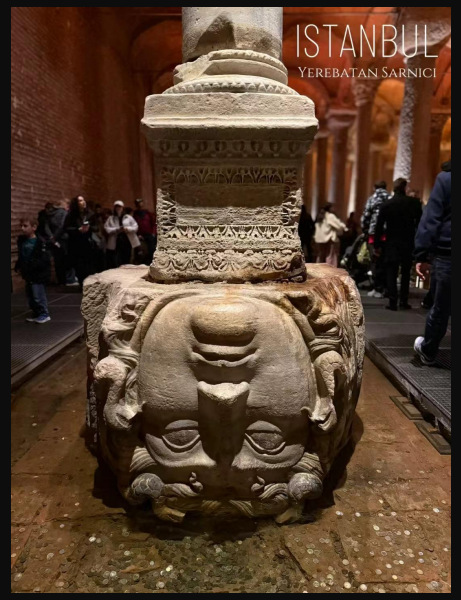
Yerebatan Sarayı

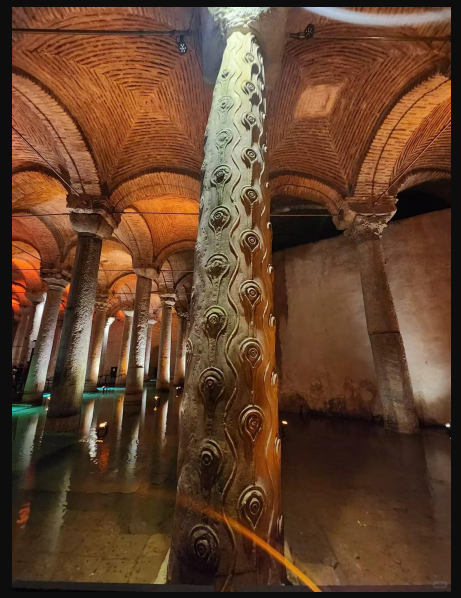
Historical Background & Scale

- Built by Byzantine Emperor Justinian I in the 6th century (532 AD), the cistern was originally designed to provide water filtration for the Great Palace and surrounding buildings. It is 140m long and 70m wide, with a capacity to hold approximately 80,000 cubic meters of water.

Architecture

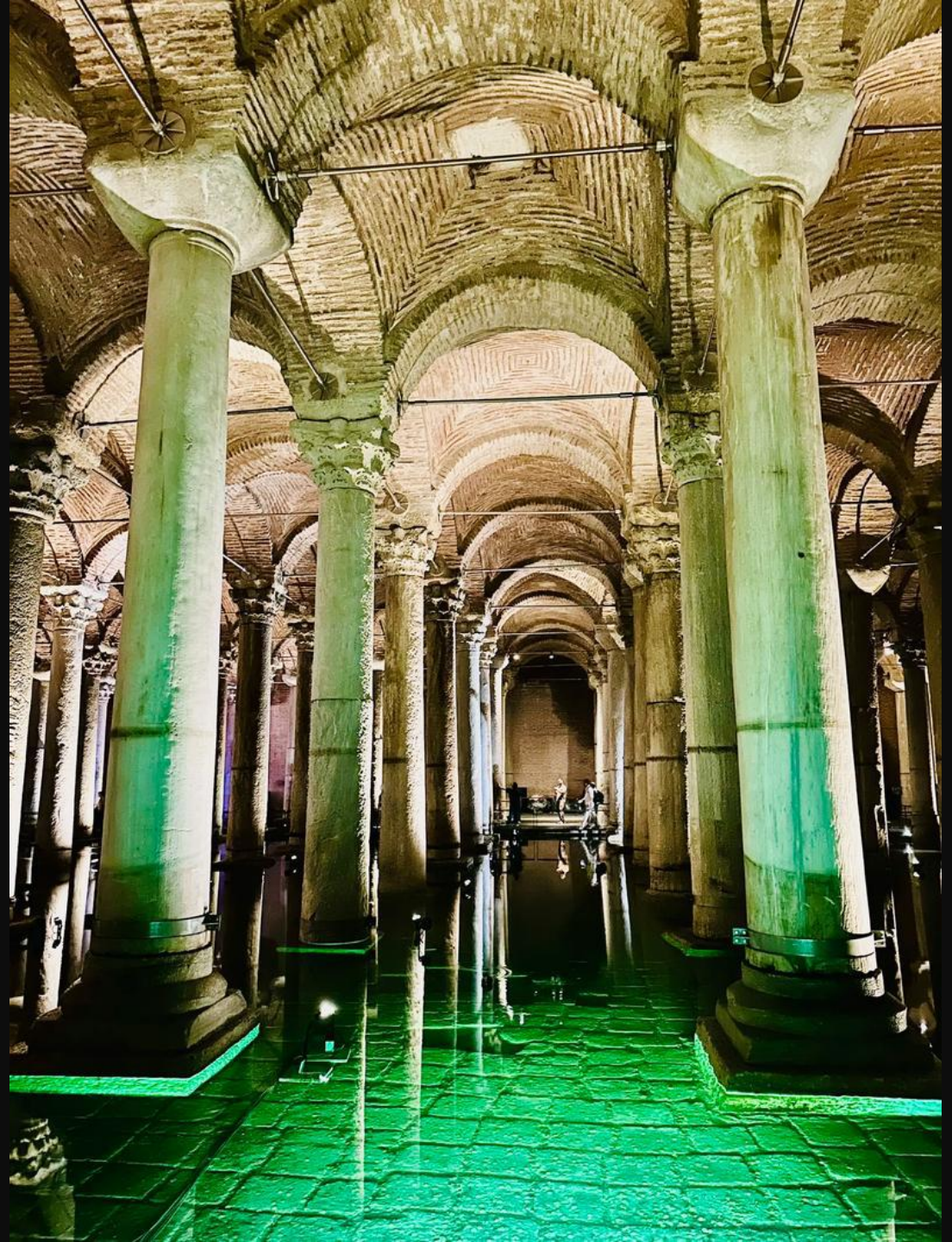
- The Forest of Columns： The cistern features 336 marble columns, each 9 meters high. Most of these columns were salvaged from the ruins of older temples, which is why they display various architectural styles (primarily Corinthian and Doric).
- The Medusa Pillar Bases： n the northwest corner, two columns rest on bases carved with the face of Medusa. One is positioned sideways and the other upside down. Legend suggests they were placed this way to negate the power of Medusa’s gaze, which could turn onlookers into stone.
- The Crying Column： This column is decorated with carvings that resemble teardrops or peacock eyes. It is said to be a tribute to the hundreds of slaves who died during the cistern's construction. The column usually remains damp, making it appear as if it is weeping.





The Unique Atmosphere

- Today, the cistern is a major tourist attraction, featuring dramatic lighting, the sound of dripping water, and raised walkways. It was even famously featured in the James Bond film From Russia with Love.



Bosphorus Bridge

the First Eurasian Bridge

Informations

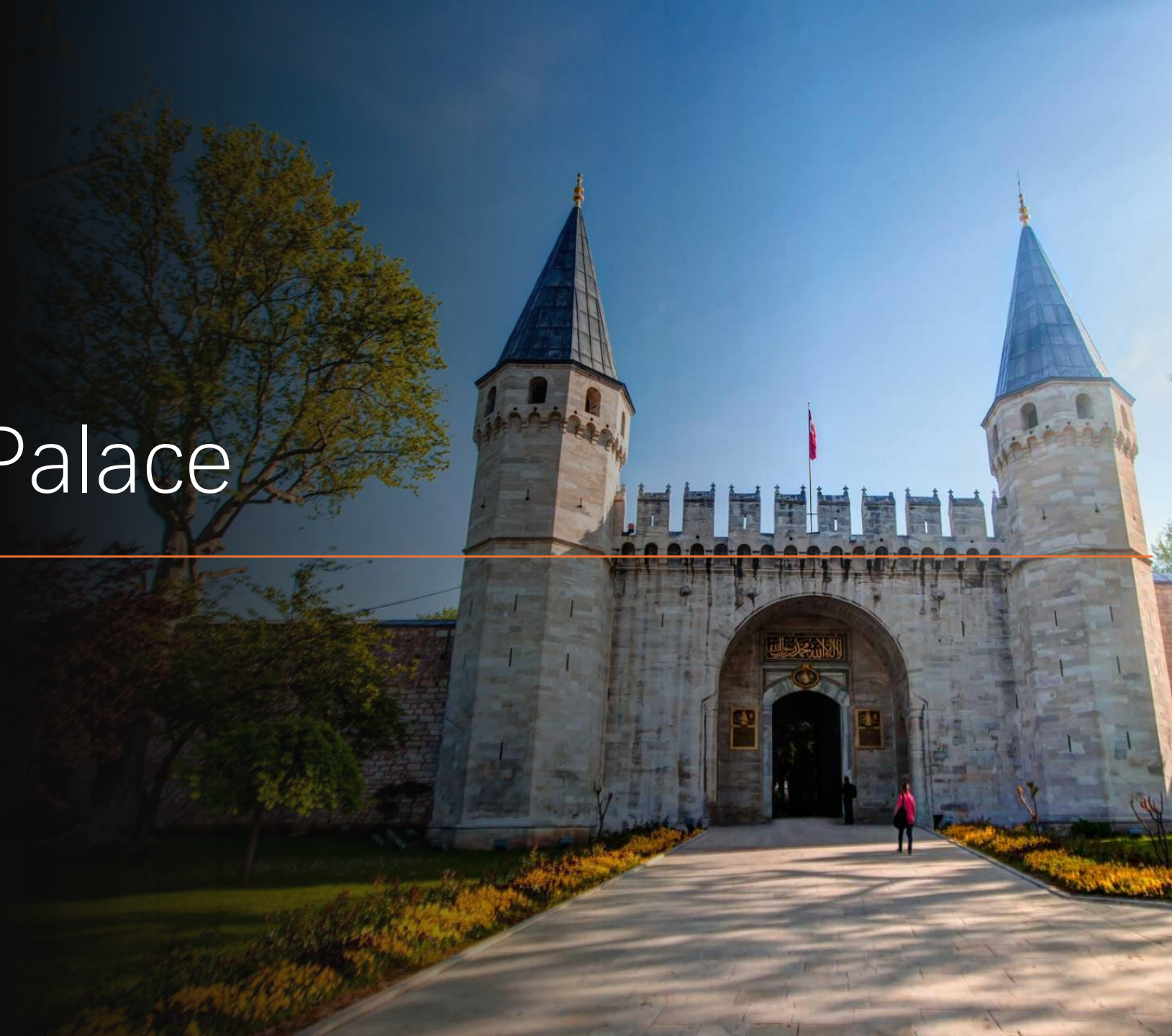
- Construction started in 1970 and was completed on October 30, 1973
- It connects Ortaköy on the European side with Beylerbeyi on the Asian side and is built at the narrowest point of the strait.
- This is the second suspension bridge across the Bosphorus Strait in Istanbul and an important Eurasian transportation artery.
- Opened to traffic in 1988, with a main span of 1090 meters, connecting Şişli in Europe and Üsküdar in Asia

Yavuz Sultan Selim Bridge

- It is the most northern modern intercontinental bridge in Istanbul with extremely high technical difficulty, and it is also a rare hybrid suspension bridge in the world where roads and railways are built on the same layer.
- Construction started on May 29, 2013, and it opened to traffic on August 26, 2016.

The Topkapı Palace

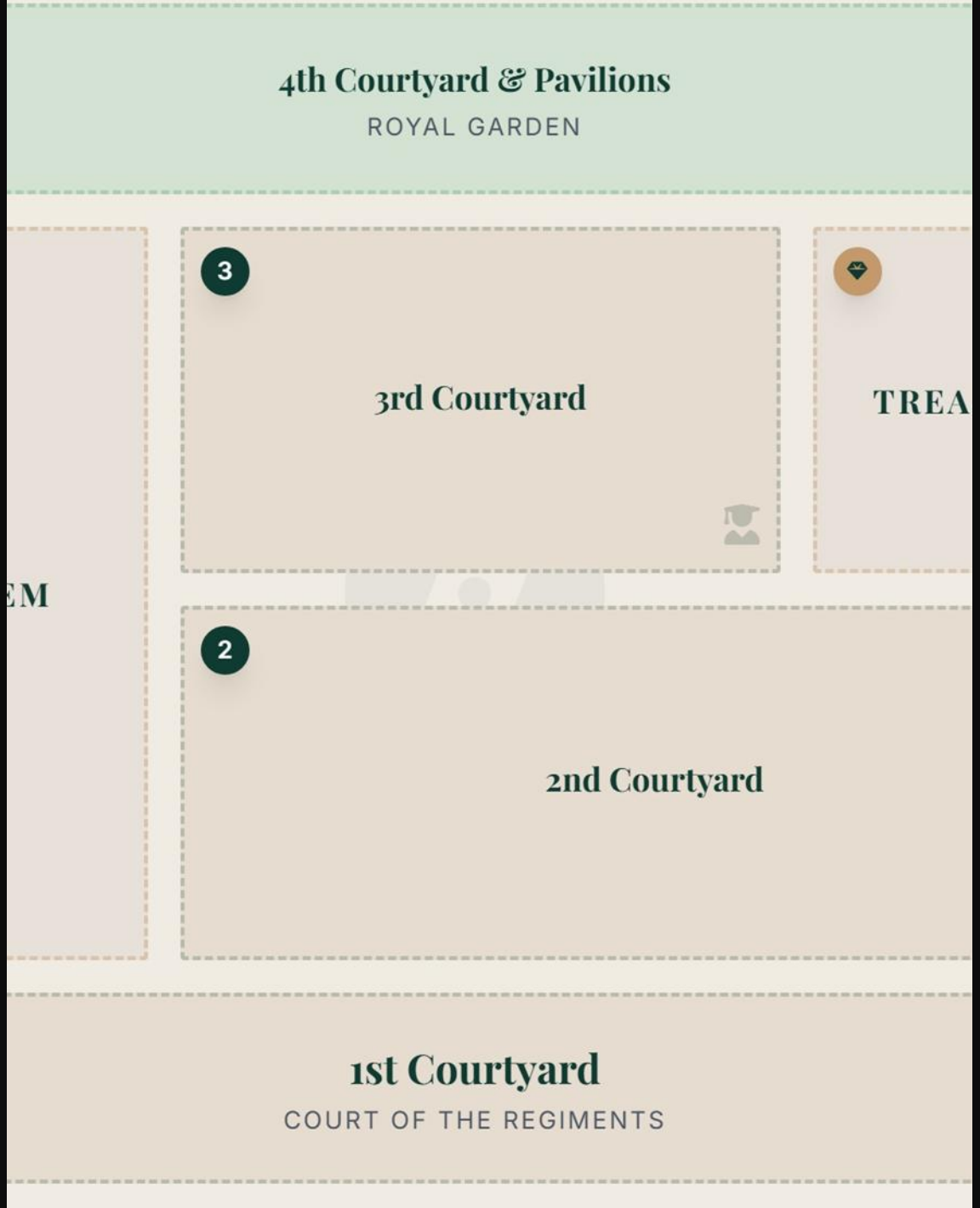
the Seraglio



Details

- The Topkapı Palace or the Seraglio, is a large museum and library in the east of the Fatih district of Istanbul in Turkey. From the 1460s to the completion of Dolmabahce Palace in 1853, it served as the administrative center of the Ottoman Empire, and was the main residence of its sultans

- Imperial Gate
- First Courtyard
- Second Courtyard
- Toggle Second Courtyard subsection
- Third Courtyard
- Toggle Third Courtyard subsection
- Harem
- Toggle Harem subsection
- Fourth Courtyard
- Toggle Fourth Courtyard subsection
- Outer gardens
- Trees



Thanks for your listening !